Finnair Sees Asia Boom as Travelers Avoid Gulf Hubs

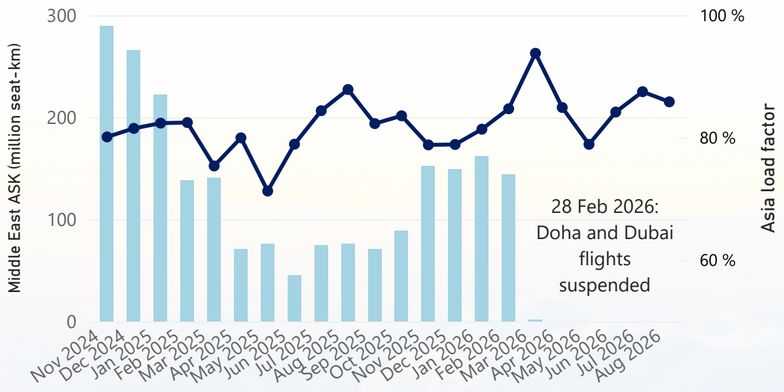
Regional traffic shifts, capacity utilisation and implied revenue drivers | November 2024 to August 2026

Karina Kovtun
November 2026

Passengers YoY | Jan–Aug 2026	Asia load factor | March	Implied revenue growth | March	Network LF | Jan–Aug 2026	Yield effect | Apr–Aug 2026	Middle East ASK | Apr–Aug 2026
7.0 %	93.8 %	24.2 %	80.0 %	9.2	0.0

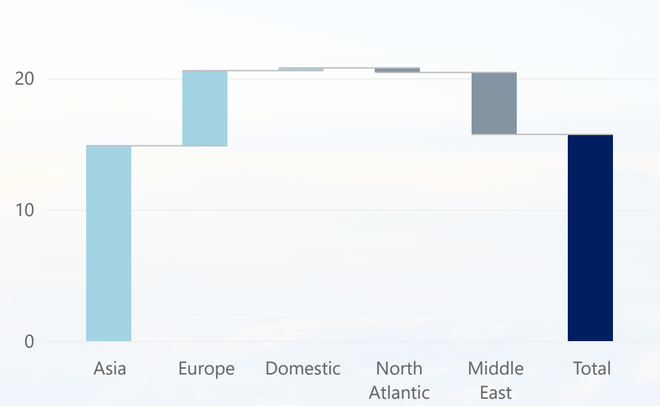
01. Asia load factor surged as Middle East capacity disappeared

Middle East ASK (m) and Asia load factor by Month



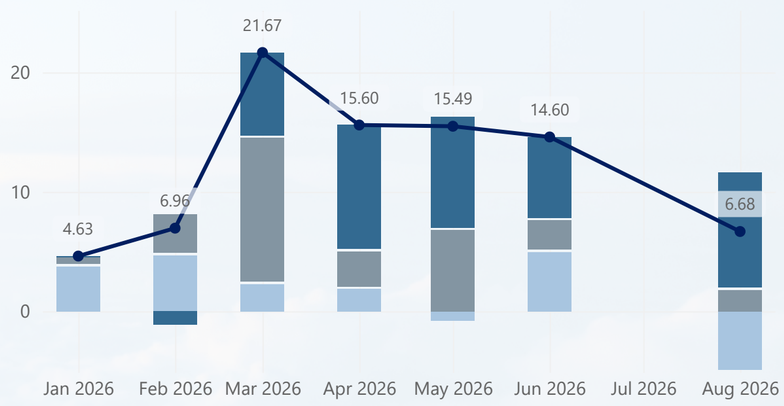
02. Asia drove most of March's network traffic growth

Contribution to network RPK growth, March 2026 (percentage points)



03. Fuller aircraft drove March's implied revenue growth

Implied revenue growth decomposition, Jan–Aug 2026 (log points)



04. Unraveling how operational drivers affect the revenue

What the analysis reveals

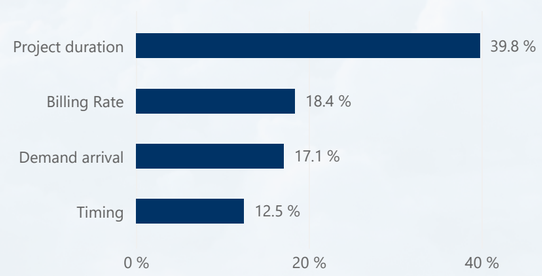
March 2026's implied revenue growth was driven by higher load factors (fuller aircraft), and not so much by capacity expansion. Asia accounted for most of the increase in network passenger traffic (Middle East capacity contracted).

What I would analyse next

Using the Monte Carlo & SimDec approach from my bachelor's thesis, I would model uncertainty in capacity, passenger load factors and revenue per RPK to assess how alternative demand scenarios could affect Finnair's revenue forecasts.

05. My thesis: What drives valuation uncertainty?

Share of NPV variance explained by selected assumptions



06. Passenger traffic remains below its 2019 baseline

Monthly passengers (thousands), Jan 2019–Aug 2026



Source: Finnair monthly traffic releases, 2019–2026. **Method:** Revenue growth inferred from ASK and RASK; decomposition expressed in log points. Revenue/RPK is a proxy, not passenger ticket yield. **Limitations:** ASK and RPK use great-circle distances; longer flight paths from Russian airspace restrictions are not fully reflected. July 2026 RASK unavailable. Data collection and method assisted by Claude; Power BI modelling and analysis completed independently. This is an independent analysis of public data.